

Technology News



Jaunty Jackalope's out! Oh, that's the latest Ubuntu

Canonical, the commercial sponsor of Ubuntu, has launched the Ubuntu 9.04 Desktop and Server Netbook Remix editions.

Ubuntu 9.04 Desktop Edition delivers shorter boot speeds, enhanced suspend-and-resume features, and intelligent switching between Wi-Fi and 3G environments. It includes the latest GNOME 2.26 desktop environment with a number of great



new features, including Brasero 2.26.0, an all-in-one CD burning application along with the default disc burning utility in Nautilus. It also comes with improved handling of multiple monitors; X.Org server 1.6; Wacom tablet hotplugging; a new style for notifications and notification preferences; significantly improved boot performance; Linux kernel 2.6.28; and optional ext4 files system support.

Meanwhile, Kubuntu 9.04 includes KDE 4.2 with many new features like significant refinements of Plasma and KWin, the KDE

workspace, many new and updated Plasma widgets, new and improved desktop effects (enabled by default), the return of the optional 'Classic Desktop' motif as an option, etc. The new inclusions in System Settings are tools for managing software and printer configuration; Quassel, a new IRC client; Amarok 2.0.2, KTorrent 3.2, Digikam 0.10.0, etc.

Enhancements in the Server Edition include improved virtualisation with the latest KVM features, clustering support in the Samba file server, and easier mail server set-ups with out-of-the-box Dovecot-Postfix integration.

Ubuntu 9.04 Netbook Remix comes with faster boot speeds, and with a built-for-purpose interface, which means that favourite applications and websites are just a click away. For the first time, users can download the complete Ubuntu Netbook Remix to a USB flash drive directly from Ubuntu.com. Users can then install and run Ubuntu Netbook Remix on a wide range of the most popular netbook machines available in the market today. Ubuntu 9.04 Netbook Remix has been fully tested for use on a range of netbook models, including Acer Aspire One, Asus eee PC 1000 and Dell Mini 9.

ISC kickstarts development of BIND 10

The Internet Systems Consortium (ISC), with the support of some sponsors, has revealed plans for BIND 10, the next leap forward in DNS server software. BIND 10 promises to be modular, highly scalable, and provides simple methods for configuration management and integration with other systems. The design goals are simple: a secure, flexible, resilient DNS server that integrates easily into the workflow and in the maintenance that complex networks demand. Additionally, BIND 10 has set a goal to provide the state-of-the-art in DNS security. The differentiation will be the way that a user configures the secure services they choose to deploy. The design goal for DNSSEC in BIND 10 is to be usable by the typical DNS administrator with built-in safeguards for management and renewal. For more information on the project and about participation, visit www.isc.org/bind10.

Development kit enables digital photo frames programming

RMI Corporation, a fabless semiconductor company that provides high-performance processors for communication and media-rich applications, has launched its Home Media Player Application Development Kit (ADK). The ADK is an open development system and includes a complete software Board Support Package (BSP) for users and original design manufacturers (ODMs) targeting media-based applications, such as wireless Digital Photo Frames (DPFs), Mobile Internet Devices (MIDs), Digital Signage, Information Dashboards and other home networking and consumer devices.

The hardware includes a 10.4-inch (26.4 cm) high resolution (1024x768) LCD, 2 GB of NAND flash, 256 MB of DDR2 RAM, Wi-Fi connectivity (through partnership with Atheros), two USB ports, Ethernet and serial ports, stereo speakers, IR receiver, and a 5-in-1 card reader. The ADK utilises the Linux OpenEmbedded environment to create a Board Support Package based on Linux 2.6.x. It



includes a media stack and player from CoreCodec for D1 resolution video playback (MPEG-1/2/4, VC1/WMV, H.264, DivX, XviD), hardware-accelerated DirectFB, GTK+ middleware, a complete tool chain, filesystem, and an example application.

The ADK is available directly from RMI or through its distribution channels for \$499.